The striking blue and white features of Neptune help to distinguish it from Uranus.

HOTS: Imagine you were on a space craft travelling at the speed of light from Earth, how long would it take to reach the Sun?

The Dwarf Planets

Dwarf planets are small celestial bodies found beyond the planet Neptune. They are extremely cold and dark. They are almost spherical in shape, but unlike planets they can share their orbit with other dwarf planets. The five dwarf planets of the solar system are Pluto, Ceres, Eris, Makemake and Haumea.

The Moon - Earth's Satellite



Moon

Satellites are celestial objects, which revolve around the planets. The moon is the Earth's only satellite. It revolves around the Earth once in every 27 days and 8 hours. It takes about the same time for it to complete one rotation around its axis. It has no atmosphere. The surface of the moon is characterized by craters created by the impact of meteors. The distance between the moon and the Earth is about 3, 84,400 km. The size of the moon is one-quarter of the Earth. The Moon is the only celestial body where humans have landed.

HOTS: We see only one side of the Moon always. Why?

Asteroids

Asteroids are small solid objects that move around the Sun. They are found as a belt between Mars and Jupiter. They are too small to be called as planets. They are also known as **Planetoids** or **Minor Planets**.

Fact:

ISRO launched India's first ever Moon mission, **Chandrayaan - 1** in 2008.

Comets

A comet is a celestial object made up of a head and a tail. The head of a comet consists of solid particles held together by ice and the tail is made up of gases. Halley's Comet is the most famous comet which comes close to the Earth every 76 years. It appeared in 1986 and will appear in 2061.



Comets

Meteors and Meteorites

A meteor is a stone like or metallic body. When entering into the Earth's atmosphere, most of them burn. As they often appear as streaks of light in the sky, they are also known as **Shooting Stars**.

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